Group 1: Alkali MetalsI(first column) of the periodic table. Sodium and potassium are examples of these elements. Alkali metals form salts and many other compounds. Form ions with a +1 charge. The alkali metals are highly reactive.

Group 2: Alkaline Earth Metals are located in Group II (second column) of the periodic table. Calcium and magnesium are examples of alkaline earths. These metals form many compounds. They have ions with a +2 charge.

Groups 3-12: Transition Metals

Iron and gold are examples of transition metals. These elements are very hard, with high melting points and boiling points. The transition metals are good electrical conductors and are very malleable. They form positively charged ions.

Metalloids

Some elements have some, but not all of the properties of the metals. These elements are called metalloids.

Group 17: Halogens

Examples of halogens are chlorine and iodine. You find these elements in bleaches, disinfectants, and salts. These nonmetals form ions with a -1 charge. The physical properties of the halogens vary. The halogens are highly reactive.

Group 18: Noble Gases

The noble gases are located in Group VIII of the periodic table. Helium and neon are examples of noble gases. These elements are used to make lighted signs, refrigerants, and lasers. The noble gases are not reactive. This is because they dont gain or lose electrons.

Hydrogen

Hydrogen has a single positive charge, like the alkali metals, but at room temperature, it is a gas that doesn't act like a metal. Therefore, hydrogen usually is labeled as a nonmetal.